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Chapter 1

What To Do First



Select Your Route Through The Information



Note: For convenience, throughout this guide, Enterprise Work Management may be referred to as Work Management or as EWM.

This help guide is for anyone involved in using Enterprise Work Management. The chapters have been organised according to tasks.

Please select Route 1 or 2 through the information:

1 Fast Learning Route

This is for anyone who needs only a general understanding of EWM but needs to learn quickly how to build Business Processes. It assumes only a basic technical knowledge.



Tip: Sales demonstrators please take this route.

2 Detailed Technical Route

This route is for System Administrators, Programmers and Technical Consultants. It assumes a strong technical background.

It explains how to prepare the Server and PCs for EWM and covers all aspects of EWM management.

A number of appendices are included which contain lists of details for all the programs and files that you may need.

Fast Learning Route



Warning: This assumes that a system has already been set up for you, to enable you to use EWM.



Warning: If you are printing sections of this Help Guide from Acrobat Viewer please check that you have the correct print resolution on your machine. Please refer to the glossary definition, Acrobat Printing Problems, for instructions.

Please use the following sections:

1 EWM Introduction

This is a short but important introduction.

2 Building AE Processes

This is a tutorial. Read this if you want to know how to build AE 1, AE 2 and AE 3 from start to finish. These are the Active Enterprise Business Processes.



Tip: There is a Getting Started section in both the Explorer and Constructor Online Help.



Tip: If you now need more technical information please go to the Detailed Technical Route.

Detailed Technical Route



Warning: If you are printing sections of this Help Guide from Acrobat Viewer please check that you have the correct print resolution on your machine. Please refer to the glossary definition, Acrobat Printing Problems, for instructions.

Please use the following sections:

1 EWM Introduction



Tip: Please read this first.

2 Building AE Processes



Tip: Read this at any time to practice using Constructor. It explains how to use the demonstration processes AE 1, AE 2 and AE 3

3 System Preparation And Administration



Tip: This is the starting point for new EWM installations.

This covers the preparation and setting up of the system, the configuration of the server and the PC. It tells you how to run EWM and discusses runtime issues.

4 Using Work Management With Explorer

Read this to understand how Work Management affects what you do and see in Explorer. Discusses Action Lists and Action Tracker.

5 Enabling Existing Elemental Activities

Read this if you have System 21 Activities which you need as part of a process and which are not currently Work Management enabled. Print Purchase Orders is used as a working example. Please use this in conjunction with Enabled Activities List (appendix).

6 Adding Data Fields

This is a tutorial. Read this to understand how to extend the list of variables available within Constructor. Please use this in conjunction with Variable Substitution Program (appendix) and Data Fields List (appendix).

7 Using Email

Read this to understand how to set up Email and use it as part of a Business Process.



Note: The remaining chapters are appendices.

8 Enabled Activities List (appendix)

Only read this if you are interested in knowing which activities have been enabled in each software version of System 21. Also refer to Enabling Existing Elemental Activities.

9 Physical Files (appendix)

Only read this if you are interested in File layouts and Field details for System Manager Physical Files and EWM Files.

10 Variable Substitution Program (appendix)

Only read this if you are interested in the RPG code in order to add Data Fields. Please use this in conjunction with Adding Data Fields and Data Fields List (appendix).

11 Data Fields List (appendix)

Only read this if you are interested in managing Data Fields. Please use this in conjunction with Adding Data Fields and Variable Substitution Program (appendix).

12 Copy Source Code (appendix)

Only read this if you are interested in the RPG code for WMNABLE COPYSRC and its subroutines, so that you can insert parts of it into programs to enable them for Work Management.

13 Troubleshooting (appendix)

Only read this if you want help quickly for a specific problem.

EWM Introduction



Tip: Everyone should read this section.

EWM is the software that delivers the business benefits of JBA's Active Enterprise Architecture, the term that describes JBA's implementation of activity task automation and control.

EWM operates on the basis of automating the flow of documents, for example Sales Orders, through their life cycle from creation through to completion, for example Order Entry through to Despatch of Goods and Creation of Invoice.

However EWM can be used not only for complete life cycle processes, but also for much more discrete ones. For example, where previously two activities such as Entering The Order and Acknowledging The Order would have been executed separately, this can now be executed as one process.

EWM seeks to improve business efficiency through the reduction of cycle time for business documents. This is achieved through the automatic execution of business processes with manual intervention triggered only where the process has defined it to be required, typically through some exception condition.

EWM has two modes of operation: Design Mode is for use with System 21 Constructor and Execution Mode is for use with System 21 Explorer.

The Engine

The EWM Engine is central to this processing. It is Server software which awaits incoming triggers which confirm the transactions that have been completed and may require the execution of a subsequent activity. There is a trigger for each completion state on a transaction, each one possibly generating a new pending transaction. The engine schedules new activities by putting them in a queue for automatic execution or adding them to an Action List in System 21 Explorer for user execution. Also the engine supports parallel and serial execution of activities.

The Work Management Engine runs in a subsystem on the Server and is part of the function provided by System 21 System Manager.

Constructor

Constructor is the Graphical Design/Configuration Tool for Work Management. This is where you use EWM in Design Mode.

- Firstly you define a Business Process by designing it on the Workspace.
- Secondly you Validate the Business Process.
- Thirdly, when you are sure that your design is error free you perform a Walkthrough to follow the logical flow of the Business Process as the user would see it.
- Finally you Activate the Business Process in order to enable it for Work Management. This involves uploading the Business Process file from the PC to the server where the EWM engine runs.

Explorer

Work Management then controls the flow of work by using System 21 Explorer as the interface for initiating its enabled activities. This is where you use EWM in Execution Mode.

EWM is transparent to the System 21 Explorer users. They launch activities through Explorer in the normal way. However the EWM engine monitors activity launches and determines if they are part of an activated process. If they are part of an activated process then the EWM engine takes control of the document and progresses it through the process.

Where the EWM engine determines that an activity must have manual input, it is directed to the appropriate users desktop for their immediate attention.

Items can be moved from one user's Action List to another user's Action List dependent on rules which you define. For example you could delegate activities when a user was on holiday or absent for a period of time so that items would appear only in the Action List of the user who was taking over that activity. Instead of moving the item to another list you could give it a higher priority after a period of time so that it moved higher up the same Action List.

Enabling Activities

In order to participate in EWM, application activities must be Work Management enabled. JBA provides a set of standard enabled activities but others can be enabled as required.



Note: This help file lists those that are currently enabled in the standard product and provides information on how to enable others.



Tip: Remember: You enable Activities but you Activate a Business Process containing activities. An activity can be enabled without being part of a Business Process.

Features



Note: Explanations for these features, and many others, are available to you in the Glossary and as pop up windows within the online help text.

These are the some of the features:

- Action Agents
- Action Tracker
- Audit
- Email
- Escalation and Delegation
- Manual Activities
- Manual Forwarding
- Process Performance
- Role Menu
- Variable Substitution Engine.



Tip: Please return now to Select Your Route Through The Information

About This Guide

Conventions

Within this guide System 21 Explorer and System 21 Constructor may be referred to as Explorer and Constructor respectively.

Within this guide Enterprise Work Management may be referred to as Work Management or as EWM.

Throughout this Product Guide, the following naming conventions are used:



Tip: This symbol represents a helpful tip in the text.



Note: This symbol represents a note in the text



Warning: This is a warning message!

Please note that System 21 Explorer and System 21 Constructor support only the configuration detailed separately on the latest System 21 Configuration Information Sheet issued by JBA Software Products Limited, although individual configurations can be agreed by/with clients and JBA Branches for local support of the product.

Assumptions

This guide assumes that you have a good appreciation of JBA's System 21 software.

This guide assumes that you are familiar with the standard elements of the Microsoft Windows interface, such as the controls for opening and closing windows, scroll bars, buttons and icons. For more information about Windows you should consult the Windows documentation.